



Butterflies and moths



A butterfly's mouth, called a proboscis, is like a long, curly straw.

With their colorful wings, butterflies are the most beautiful insects. Moths are less colorful because most of them fly at night.

Scaly wings

Butterflies smell with their antennae.

Head

Defense

Eyespots on the wings of this butterfly frighten enemies away.

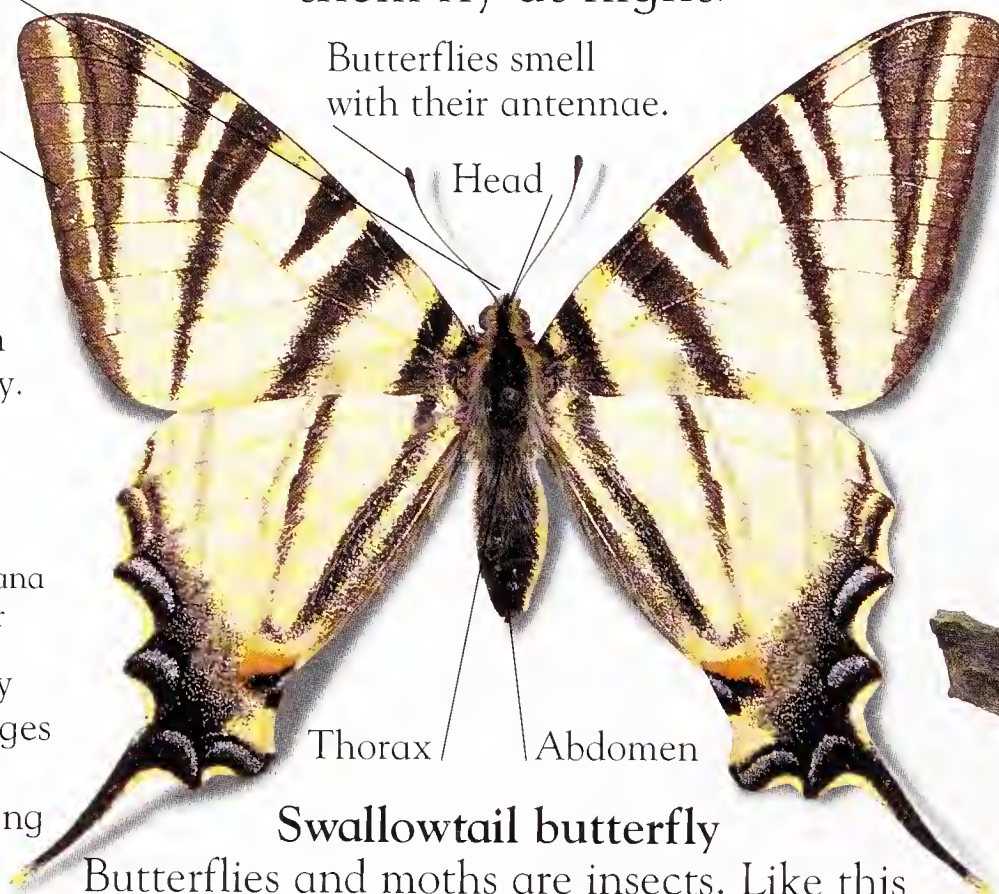


Banana eater

This butterfly camouflages itself by pretending to be a leaf.



Leaf butterfly



Swallowtail butterfly

Butterflies and moths are insects. Like this swallowtail, they all have three body parts, six legs, and four large wings.

Growing up

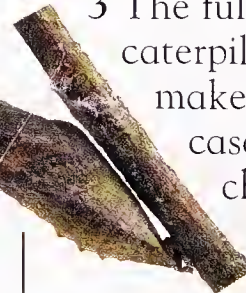


1 Butterfly eggs hatch out into caterpillars.

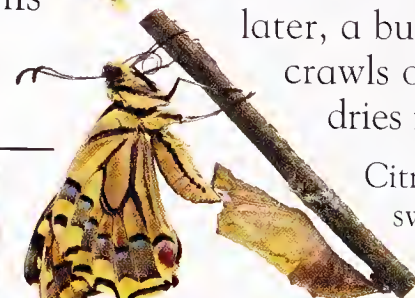


2 A caterpillar grows so fast it must keep shedding its skin.

3 The fully grown caterpillar slowly makes a hard case called a chrysalis.



4 About four weeks later, a butterfly crawls out and dries its wings.



Citrus swallowtail

Moth facts



Thick, furry body



Large, feathery antennae



Wings spread out when resting

Butterfly facts



Slender body



Smooth antennae with clublike ends



Wings folded when resting

Did you know?

This African moth has a proboscis three times as long as its body to suck nectar from exotic flowers.

